

Roopkund Trek — The Mystery Lake

8 DAYS / 7 NIGHTS · EX-KATHGODAM · A HIGH-ALTITUDE EXPEDITION

Roopkund is the famous "Skeleton Lake" at nearly 5,000 m, ringed by ancient human bones and crowned by Trishul and Nanda Ghunti. The journey crosses two of India's grandest alpine meadows — Ali and Bedni Bugyal — before the thin-air push to the lake and the Junargali ridge. This is a serious, bucket-list high-altitude trek for fit, experienced trekkers, not a first trek.

Trek at a glance

Trek	Roopkund — glacial "mystery lake", via Ali & Bedni Bugyal
Highest point	~5,029 m / ~16,499 ft (Roopkund); Junargali ridge ~5,100 m
Base village	Lohajung (~2,350 m / 7,700 ft), Chamoli district
Road head	Kathgodam (~210 km, 9–10 hr drive to Lohajung) · Dehradun pickup on request
Duration	8 days / 7 nights (Kathgodam to Kathgodam)
Trek distance	~53 km total round trip
Difficulty	Difficult — high altitude, long summit day; prior trekking experience needed
Best season	May–Jun & Sep–Oct

Day-by-day itinerary

Day 1 — Kathgodam → Lohajung ~2,350 m · ~210 km · 9–10 hr drive

Pickup from Kathgodam and a scenic drive via Almora and Gwaldam to Lohajung. Briefing and gear check. Overnight in a guesthouse.

Day 2 — Lohajung → Didna ~2,500 m · short drive + ~7 km trek · 4–5 hr

Drive to Kulling, then trek across the Neel Ganga and climb to the hamlet of Didna. Overnight in a village stay / tents.

Day 3 — Didna → Ali Bugyal → Bedni Bugyal ~3,350 m · ~11 km · 6–7 hr

A breathtaking day onto the vast Ali and Bedni meadows, with Trishul and Nanda Ghunti filling the sky. Camp at Bedni. Overnight in tents.

Day 4 — Bedni Bugyal → Patar Nachauni ~3,800 m · ~5 km · 3–4 hr

A steady climb past Ghora Lotani to Patar Nachauni. Acclimatisation walk in the evening. Overnight in tents.

Day 5 — Patar Nachauni → Bhagwabasa ~4,100 m · ~5 km · 3–4 hr

A short but demanding climb via Kalu Vinayak to Bhagwabasa, the high camp before the summit. Rest and hydrate. Overnight in tents.

Day 6 — Bhagwabasa → Roopkund → Junargali → descend to Bedni/Patar ~5,029 m · ~12 km · 8–10 hr

Summit day: a pre-dawn start for the thin-air climb to Roopkund lake and the Junargali ridge for staggering views, then a long descent to a lower camp. The hardest, most rewarding day. Overnight in tents.

Day 7 — Descend to Wan → Lohajung ~2,350 m · ~10 km + drive · 5–6 hr

Descend through forest to Wan village and drive back to Lohajung. Hot meal and a comfortable night in a guesthouse.

Day 8 — Lohajung → Kathgodam ~210 km · 9–10 hr drive

After breakfast, drive back to Kathgodam, arriving by evening.

What's included

- Transport — Kathgodam–Lohajung round trip + local transfers
- All meals from Day 1 dinner to Day 8 breakfast
- Guesthouse (Lohajung) + tents on trek (triple share)
- Sleeping bags, mattresses & camping equipment
- Certified high-altitude trek leader, guides, cook & staff
- Forest permits & camping charges
- Safety gear: first-aid, oxygen cylinders, oximeter, microspikes & gaiters

What to pack

- Heavy down jacket + waterproof shell (top & bottom)
- Thermals, fleece, warm hat, gloves (warm + liner)
- Sturdy waterproof boots, gaiters, thermal socks
- Headlamp, 2 L water, UV sunglasses, SPF 50+, lip balm
- Personal medication, trekking poles, ID proof, daypack

What's not included

- Travel to / from Kathgodam
- Meals during the road journey
- Personal trekking gear & clothing
- Porter / mule to offload backpack (on request)
- Travel insurance (strongly recommended add-on)
- Anything not listed under inclusions; GST if applicable

Booking & cancellation

- 25% advance to confirm; balance before departure.
- Cancel >30 days: full refund less admin fee.
- 15–30 days: 50% retained. Under 15 days: no refund.
- We reschedule or offer credit if we cancel a batch for safety.

Difficulty, altitude & access — please read

This is a Difficult, high-altitude trek. You will reach ~5,029 m with a long summit day, where the risk of Acute Mountain Sickness is real. Prior trekking experience, genuine cardio fitness (we recommend 4–6 weeks of training), and proper acclimatisation are essential. Our guides carry oxygen and a pulse oximeter, run daily health checks, keep groups small, and will turn anyone — or the whole group — back if the mountain or your body says no. Travel insurance covering high-altitude trekking is strongly advised.

Access note: camping and access near Roopkund have at times been restricted by the forest department / authorities on environmental grounds. We confirm the current, official access status before every departure and will adjust the route honestly if the final stretch is closed. We never risk a fine or the fragile site to "deliver the lake".

To book or get current batch dates, pricing & access status — WhatsApp [+91 89248 13959](tel:+918924813959) · ✉ hello@tripomonk.com
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